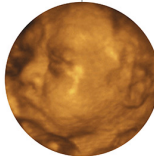


Welcome to your third trimester

“Excitement and anticipation mark this trimester, as you prepare for labor and count down to meeting your baby.”

WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK	WEEK		
26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40			
				WEEK 30: WRITE YOUR BIRTH PLAN As you imagine what your delivery might look like, it can help to create a birth plan. This can help organize conversation about your preferences, such as pain-relief options, with your doctor. The plan is useful, too, for your birth partner, who may need to advocate for you once you are in labor.												YOU AND YOUR BABY AT 40 WEEKS Your baby is engaged in the pelvis, hopefully head down, ready to be born. The skull bones are separated by membranes that allow for movement and easier passage of the head through the birth canal. As you reach your due date, it's normal to experience a wide range of emotions as you await your baby's arrival.	
Your baby will often stick their tongue out, especially after swallowing a big gulp of amniotic fluid. WEEK 26: START PRENATAL CLASSES For many women and their partners, going to prenatal classes signals the start of their labor and birth preparations. Meeting other parents-to-be, and sharing this amazing life experience can be the start of new and long-lasting new friendships.				Although your baby often sleeps, the eyes will open for short periods of time. 				You will become increasingly aware of your baby's limbs. The less space there is, the more kicks and punches you will feel! WEEK 36: PACK YOUR HOSPITAL BAG As your due date approaches, you'll feel more prepared if you get your hospital bag ready, so start gathering essential items for both you and your baby. You will find a useful checklist of things to bring on p.358. You may also want to prepare things at home so you are ready for when your baby arrives.				At 37 weeks, your baby is considered full term and will continue to grow and gain weight until delivery. 					